

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12409798
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Shi; Roy Ruijia

Powerblock for electrically powering equipment in a vehicle

Abstract

A mobile power system for electrically powering equipment in a vehicle, where the system contains two electrical circuits operating at two different voltages. One of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the batteries onboard the mobile power system, and the other of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the vehicle battery. Voltage converting chargers couple the two circuits so that an external source power supply can flow to both electrical circuits, power can flow from one circuit to the other, power can flow from either or both of the two circuits to a combination inverter charger in the mobile power system, or a combination thereof.

Inventors:	Shi; Roy Ruijia (Austin, TX)
Applicant:	Absolute Health & Performance, Inc. (Austin, TX)
Family ID:	91584824
Assignee:	Absolute Health & Performance, Inc. (Austin, TX)
Appl. No.:	18/757694
Filed:	June 28, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240351540 A1	Oct. 24, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 18146860 20221227 US 12049180 child-doc US 18757694

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B60R16/033 (20060101); **B60R16/04** (20060101); **H02J3/38** (20060101); **H02J7/00** (20060101); **H02J7/35** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC B60R16/033 (20130101); **B60R16/04** (20130101); **H02J3/381** (20130101); **H02J7/0031** (20130101); **H02J7/0042** (20130101); **H02J7/0047** (20130101); **H02J7/35** (20130101); **H02J2207/20** (20200101); **H02J2300/26** (20200101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B60R (16/033); H02J (3/381); H02J (7/0042); H02J (7/35); H02J (2207/20); H02J (2300/26)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
12049180	12/2023	Shi	N/A	H02J 7/0031
2007/0252435	12/2006	Coe et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0241306	12/2012	Aber et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0177008	12/2019	Tiedtke et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0109317	12/2021	Tiedtke et al.	N/A	N/A

Primary Examiner: Barnie; Rexford N

Assistant Examiner: Pham; Duc M

Attorney, Agent or Firm: KLEMCHUK PLLC

Background/Summary

(1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/146,860, filed Dec. 27, 2022, which is incorporated by reference for all purposes.

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to mobile power systems that supply electrical power to equipment in a vehicle.

BACKGROUND

(2) Mobile service and product providers can utilize a vehicle to provide the mobile service or product. Examples of these vehicles are food trucks and mobile medical vehicles having medical equipment. These vehicle can include equipment contained within the vehicle that require electrical power to provide the service and/or to make the product. In cases where the power provided by the vehicle itself (e.g., from the alternator run by an internal combustion engine (ICE), from the battery in an ICE vehicle, or from a battery pack in an electric vehicle to power electric motors) is not enough to power the equipment, the mobile service and product provider can supplement and/or replace the vehicle power with other sources of power, such as fuel driven generators or additional batteries dedicated to power the equipment. When batteries are used, a battery cage holds the batteries so that the batteries do not move when the vehicle moves. The batteries and battery cage are typically located under the floor of the vehicle. The batteries are not easily accessible for

maintenance and/or replacement, and cannot be moved from vehicle to vehicle.

(3) There is a need for a mobile power system to power equipment in vehicles.

SUMMARY

(4) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a mobile power system for equipment in a vehicle, including: a base; a battery pack including a plurality of rechargeable batteries placed on the base; an equipment cage connected to the base, wherein the equipment cage includes a mounting member; a circuit board connected to the equipment cage above the battery pack, wherein the circuit board includes a first electrical circuit operating at a first voltage, a second electrical circuit operating at a second voltage, and a plurality of chargers, wherein each of the plurality of chargers is electrically connected to the first electrical circuit and to the second electrical circuit, wherein the battery pack is electrically coupled to the first electrical circuit, wherein the second electrical circuit is configured to electrically connect to a vehicle battery; and a combination inverter charger placed on a mounting member of the equipment cage above the battery pack and to a side of the circuit board, wherein the combination inverter charger is electrically connected to the first electrical circuit and is configured to i) provide a first voltage power supply to charge the plurality of rechargeable batteries in the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, ii) receive a battery pack power supply from the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, and iii) provide a first 120V power supply to the equipment in the vehicle.

(5) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a mobile power system for equipment in a vehicle, including: a base; a battery pack including a plurality of rechargeable batteries placed on the base; an equipment cage connected to the base, wherein the equipment cage includes a mounting member; a 3D circuit board connected to the equipment cage above the battery pack, wherein the 3D circuit board includes a first voltage bus bar, wherein the battery pack is electrically coupled to the first voltage bus bar; and a combination inverter charger placed on a mounting member of the equipment cage above the battery pack and to a side of the 3D circuit board, wherein the combination inverter charger is electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar of the 3D circuit board and is configured to i) receive a first 120V power supply from a grid connection or from a generator, ii) provide a first voltage power supply to the first voltage bus bar, and iii) provide a second 120V power supply.

(6) In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a mobile power system for equipment in a vehicle, including: a base; a battery pack including a plurality of rechargeable batteries placed on the base; an equipment cage connected to the base, wherein the equipment cage includes a mounting member; a 3D circuit board connected to the equipment cage above the battery pack, wherein the 3D circuit board has a 24V bus bar, wherein the battery pack is electrically coupled to the 24V bus bar; and a combination inverter charger placed on a mounting member of the equipment cage above the battery pack and to a side of the 3D circuit board, wherein the combination inverter charger is electrically connected to the 24V bus bar of the 3D circuit board and is configured to i) receive a first 120V power supply from a grid connection or from a generator, ii) provide a 24V power supply to the 24V bus bar, and iii) provide a second 120V power supply.

(7) Other technical features may be readily apparent to one skilled in the art from the following figures, descriptions and claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) For a more complete understanding of this disclosure, reference is now made to the following description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a side elevational view of the disclosed mobile power system.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a corner elevational view of the mobile power system.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a top perspective view of the base, battery pack, and cage of the mobile power system.

(5) FIGS. 4 and 5 illustrate isolated perspective views of a lower board and upper board of the circuit board of the mobile power system, when the circuit board is embodied as a 3D circuit board.

(6) FIG. 6 illustrates a perspective view of the mobile power system with walls enclosing the cage, the battery pack, the combination inverter charger, and the 3D circuit board.

(7) FIG. 7 illustrates a wiring diagram of the mobile power system in FIGS. 1 to 6.

(8) FIG. 8 illustrates a side view of a van having the mobile power system connected to seat mounts in the van.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) As used herein, the term “3D” refers to three dimensional. In context of the 3D circuit board disclosed herein, “3D” means that at least some wiring extends in a Z dimension between two planes of the circuit board that extend in the X and Y dimensions (referred to herein as upper board and lower board). These dimension are relative to a top view of the mobile power system.

(10) Disclosed is a mobile power system, also referred to herein as a powerblock. The powerblock is a multi-level fully integrated power system that can be installed in a vehicle within the footprint of a seat in the vehicle. The powerblock includes a battery pack having at least one battery, an equipment cage, a circuit board, and a combination inverter charger. The power block can be mounted to vehicle seat mounts in a vehicle, and thus, the batteries in the powerblock are above the floor of the vehicle and are contained in the powerblock itself, providing mobility easy access for maintenance or replacement of the batteries. Moreover, the powerblock can be mounted to different seat locations in the vehicle or moved from one vehicle to another (e.g., when a vehicle is totaled in a crash but the powerblock can continue to be used in a replacement vehicle), while maintaining the ability of the powerblock to be charged from multiple power sources and to provide a power supply to equipment in the vehicle, in one small and consolidated footprint.

(11) FIGS. 1 to 6 show the mobile power system **1000** without wiring in between the components, for clarity. The electric connections between various components are described herein, and in practice, the electrical connection between any two components can be made with copper wire or other industry-accepted electrically conducting wire having any industry-standard AWG, such as 10 AWG, 8 AWG, 2 AWG, or combinations thereof.

(12) The mobile power system **1000** contains two circuits operating at two different voltages. One of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the batteries onboard the mobile power system **1000**, and the other of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the vehicle battery (e.g., a battery for an ICE vehicle or a battery pack for an electric vehicle). Voltage converting chargers couple the two circuits so that 1) outside source power supply can flow to both electrical circuits, 2) power can flow from one circuit to the other, 3) power can flow from either or both of the two circuits to a combination inverter charger to provide a 120V power supply, or a combination thereof. For description purposes, the two circuits will be described below as a 12V circuit operating at 12 volts and a 24V circuit operating at 24 volts. In practice, a mobile power system **1000** can be manufactured with two circuits having other voltages, and the scope of this application is not limited only to a combination of a 12V circuit and a 24V circuit.

(13) FIG. 1 illustrates a side elevational view of the disclosed mobile power system **1000**, and FIG. 2 illustrates a corner elevational view of the mobile power system **1000**. The following description applies to both FIG. 1 and FIG. 2.

(14) The mobile power system **1000** includes a base **100**, an equipment cage **200**, a battery pack **300**, a combination inverter charger **600**, and a circuit board **700**.

(15) The base **100** is configured to support the components of the mobile power system **1000** on top of the base **100**, and configured to connect to a seat mount of a vehicle on bottom of the base **100**. For connection to one or more seat mounts, the base **100** has first member **101** that is parallel

with a second member **102**, with a cross member **103** extending between and connected to each of the first member **101** and the second member **103**. In aspects, the base **100** can be installed and secured into seat mounts of a vehicle using NTSB crash tested mounting hardware. A flat plate **104** of the base **100** is placed on top of the first member **101**, the second member **102**, and the cross member **103**. The flat plate **104** provides the surface on which the other components of the mobile power system **1000** are placed.

(16) The equipment cage **200** is connected to the base **100**. The equipment cage **200** comprises horizontal members (e.g., members **220**, **221**, **222**, and **223**) and vertical members (e.g., **210**, **211**, and **212**). Each of the horizontal members connects to two of the vertical members. Each of the members (e.g., members **210**, **211**, **212**, **220**, **221**, **222**, and **223**) can be formed of tubular metal and arranged to hold within the equipment cage **200** and to protect the electrical components of the mobile power system **1000** from movement and external impact. More details about the arrangement of the members of the equipment cage **200** is described for and illustrated in FIG. 3.

(17) That battery pack **300** is placed on the top of the base **100**. The battery pack **300** can contain at least one battery. Each battery can be referred to as a battery cell, or each battery can contain multiple battery cells. In FIG. 1 the battery pack contains two batteries **301** and **302**. In aspects, the batteries **301** and **302** in the battery pack **300** are rechargeable. Suitable rechargeable batteries include lithium polymer (LiPO) batteries, lithium ion (Li-ion) batteries, nickel cadmium (NiCd) batteries, nickel metal hydride (NiMH) batteries, or combinations thereof. The batteries **301** and **302** of the battery pack can be of any voltage, such as 12V or 24V. While the batteries **301** and **302** can be of any voltage that is the voltage of the first electrical circuit on the circuit board **700**.

(18) The circuit board **700** is connected to the equipment cage **200** above the battery pack **300**. The circuit board **700** has at least two electrical circuits, where the at least one electrical circuit has a different voltage than at least another electrical circuit. For example, the circuit board **700** can have wiring and components for a 12V circuit and a 24V circuit. In aspects, the circuit board **700** is a 3D circuit board having at least two levels, e.g., a lower board **400** and an upper board **500**. Each of the two electrical circuits can utilize one or more of the levels. For example, at least a portion of the first electrical circuit can have electrical components on one or both of the lower board **400** and the upper board **500**, and at least a portion of the second electrical circuit can have electrical components on one or both of the lower board **400** and the upper board **500**.

(19) The lower board **400** and the upper board **500** are separated by spacers **401** that are positioned between the lower board **400** and the upper board **500**. Each of the spacers **401** has a height suitable for clearance of the electrical components on the lower board **400** under the upper board **500**. In aspects, the spacers **401** can be 3D printed. The spacers **401** are generally formed of a material that is not electrically conductive, such as wood, glass, or polymer. Each spacer **401** can have an end connected (e.g., via bolt or adhesive or friction) to the lower board **400** and an opposite end connected (e.g., via bolt or adhesive or friction) to the upper board **500**. The spacers **401** can have any three-dimensional shape such as cylindrical or cuboid. The electrical components on the lower board **400** are described in the description for FIG. 4, and the electrical components of the upper board **500** are described in the description for FIG. 5.

(20) In aspects, the lower board **400** and the upper board **500** can each be formed of machined wood or polymer, with holes formed in locations and configured to allow wires to pass through the holes, the wires connecting electrical components of the lower board **400** to electrical components of the upper board **500** in one of the electrical circuits. The electrical components of the circuit board **700** are connected by wires that are not encased in the circuit board **700**. Moreover, it should be noted that the circuit board **700** is not made from silicon wafers. That is, the circuit board **700** is not comparable with a silicon wafer based chipset at least because the circuit board **700** is not formed using silicon wafers and because the wires connecting electrical components on the circuit board **700** are not encased in the circuit board **700**.

(21) The combination inverter charger **600** is configured to receive a 120V power supply from a

grid connection or from a generator, to provide a 24V power supply to the circuit board **700**, and to provide a 20V power supply to equipment in the vehicle that is connected to a 120V outlet of the mobile power system **1000** (e.g., see outlet **602** in FIG. 6). The combination inverter charger **600** is placed on the equipment cage **200** above the battery pack **300** and to the side of the 3D circuit board **700**. When grid or generator power is disconnected from the mobile power system **1000**, the inverter within the combination inverter charger **600** can be activated to take over the supply of electric power to the connected equipment from the battery pack **300**. An example of a combination inverter charger **600** is the MULTIPLUS® combination inverter charger available from Victron Energy.

(22) The mobile power system **1000** can also include a top cover **1001** having a circuit breaker **601** and a 120V outlet **602** placed therein. The circuit breaker **601** is configured to connect or disconnect the combination inverter charger **600** from a first 120V power supply (e.g., see grid **701** or generator **702** in FIG. 7), wherein the 120V outlet **602** is electrically connected to the combination inverter charger **600** and configured to receive a 120V power supply from the combination inverter charger **600**.

(23) FIG. 3 illustrates a top perspective view of the base **100**, the equipment cage **200**, and battery pack **300** of the mobile power system **1000**. The batteries **301** and **302** of the battery pack **300** are on top of the flat plate **104** of the base. The vertical members **210**, **211**, **212**, and **213** are placed in the corners of the flat plate **104** of the base **100**. The horizontal members **220**, **222**, **224**, and **226** can be as each being connected to two vertical members, e.g., horizontal member **220** has an end connected to vertical member **210** and an opposite end connected to vertical member **211**, horizontal member **222** has an end connected to vertical member **211** and an opposite end connected to vertical member **212**, horizontal member **224** has an end connected to vertical member **212** and an opposite end connected to vertical member **213**, and horizontal member **226** has an end connected to vertical member **213** and an opposite end connected to vertical member **210**. Mounting members **227** and **228** can be seen extending between a parallel pair of the horizontal members **222** and **226**. The combination inverter charger **600** can be placed on the mounting members **227** and **228**, and mounting members **227** and **228** function as structural support for the combination inverter charger **600** and to protect the battery pack **300** that is below the mounting members **227** and **228** from the weight of the combination inverter charger **600**.

(24) FIGS. 4 and 5 illustrate isolated perspective views of a lower board and upper board of the circuit board, when the circuit board is embodied as a 3D circuit board.

(25) In FIG. 4, the combination inverter charger **600** be seen placed to the side of the lower board **400**. Spacers **401** can be seen placed on the perimeter of the lower board **400** and configured with a height that provides a vertical clearance of all the electrical components mounted and connected to the lower board **400**.

(26) The lower board **400** can include one or more 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409**, a circuit breaker **404**, a battery monitor device **405**, one or more dual 24V bus bars **406** and **407**, and circuit breaker **410** that are mounted, attached, connected, or otherwise coupled to the lower board **400**.

(27) Four 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409** are illustrated in FIG. 4. The 12V bus bars electrically connect electrical components in the 12V circuit of the 3D circuit board **700**. One or more of the 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409** is/are electrically connected to a vehicle battery of the vehicle in which the mobile power system **1000** is contained. One or more of the 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409** is/are additionally electrically connected to chargers (e.g., chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506**) that are located in the upper board **500** (described in more detail below).

(28) The circuit breaker **404** electrically connects the battery pack **300** to the 24V circuit (e.g., via one or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407**). The circuit breaker **404** is configured to disconnect the battery pack **300** from the 24V circuit upon a circuit breaking condition, such as a power surge.

(29) The battery monitor device **405** is electrically connected to the 24V circuit via one or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407**. The battery monitor device **405** is also operably connected to a

control computer on the upper board **500** (described in more detail herein). The battery monitor device **405** can be configured to monitor parameters of the batteries **301** and **302** in the battery pack **300**, such as the state of charge, the time to go, historical information, or combinations thereof. The battery monitor device **405** can additionally be configured to send a signal to the control computer on the upper board **500**, where the signal represents a status of each battery of a status of the battery pack **300**, or the status of the battery pack **300**. In aspects, the battery monitor device **405** can include a shunt coupled with a computer that the current and voltage across the shunt. When the mobile power system **1000** is not connected to an outside power source (e.g., grid **701** or generator **702**), the batteries in the battery pack **300** provide power to the 24V circuit, and the voltage and current of the power are determined by the computer connected to the shunt of the battery monitor device **405**. The computer of the battery monitor device **405** can be equipped with a communication device, such as a transceiver, to communicate with a mobile device of a user via Bluetooth or wireless signal, for example. An example of the battery monitor device **405** is the SMARTSHUNT® available from Victron Energy.

(30) Two dual 24V bus bars **406** and **407** are illustrated in FIG. 4. The 24V bus bars **406** and **407** electrically connect electrical components in the 24V circuit of the 3D circuit board **700**. One or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407** is electrically connected to the combination inverter charger **600**, to receive a 24V power supply from the combination inverter charger **600** for charging the battery pack **300** and/or the vehicle battery and to provide a 24V power supply to the combination inverter charger **600** when using the battery pack **300** as power supply to the 120V electrical outlet **602** that is electrically connected to the combination inverter charger **600**. One or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407** of the lower board **400** is/are additionally configured to electrically connect to the chargers (e.g., chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506** in FIG. 5) of the upper board **500**.

(31) The circuit breaker **410** electrically connects the vehicle battery of the vehicle to the 12V circuit (e.g., via one or more of the 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409**). The circuit breaker **410** is configured to disconnect the vehicle battery from the 12V circuit upon a circuit breaking condition, such as a power surge.

(32) In FIG. 5, the combination inverter charger **600** be seen placed to the side of the upper board **500**. The upper board **500** can include chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506**, a control computer **502**, and a solar charge controller **504**.

(33) Chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506** can be configured as DC-DC chargers. In aspects, the chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506** can be 3-stage chargers. In aspects, the chargers **501** and **503** are first voltage to second voltage chargers, and the chargers **505** and **506** are second voltage to first voltage chargers. For example, chargers **501** and **503** can be 24V to 12V chargers, and chargers **505** and **506** can be 12V to 24V chargers. Each charger is configured to receive an input power supply at one voltage and to convert the input power supply to an output power supply at another voltage. The direction of power conversion through the chargers depends on whether a battery is being charged or used for power. Each charger is configured to connect to the first electrical circuit and the second electrical circuit, the first electrical circuit having a first voltage and the second electrical circuit having a second voltage. An example of first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503** and second voltage to first voltage chargers **505/506** is the ORION® Tr Smart DC-DC Charger available from Victron Energy.

(34) Using 24V and 12V as reference for the first voltage and the second voltage, respectively, the 12V to 24V charger(s) **505/506** are electrically connected to one or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407** and to one or more of the 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409**. The 12V to 24V charger(s) **505/506** are configured to receive a 12V power supply from the vehicle battery via the 12V bus bar(s) **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409**, and to convert the received 12V power supply to an output 24V power supply. The output 24V power supply that is output by the 12V to 24V charger(s) **505/506** can be used to 1) charge the batteries **301** and **302** in the battery pack **300** via a 24V bus bar, 2) provide a 24V power supply to the combination inverter charger **600** via a 24V bus bar, which then

converts the 24V power supply to a 120V power supply to the 120V electrical outlet **602**, or both 1) and 2).

(35) Using 24V and 12V as reference for the first voltage and the second voltage, respectively, the 24V to 12V charger(s) **501/503** are electrically connected to one or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407** and to one or more of the 12V bus bars **402**, **403**, **408**, and **409**. The 24V to 12V charger(s) **501/503** are configured to receive a 24V power supply from the 24V bus bar(s) **406** and **407** of the lower board **400** (which receives the 24V power supply from the battery pack **300** and/or the combination inverter charger **600**), and to convert the received 24V power supply to an output 12V power supply. The output 12V power supply that is output by the 24V to 12V chargers **501/503** can be used to charge the vehicle battery via the 12V bus bar.

(36) The control computer **502** is positioned on the upper board **500**. The control computer **502** is electrically connected to one or more of the 24V bus bars **406** and **407** in the lower board **400** and operably connected to the combination inverter charger **600**. The control computer **502** can be configured to monitor the state of charge of batteries **301** and **302** in the battery pack **300**, monitor power consumption of equipment connected to the mobile power system **1000**, monitor power harvest (e.g., from PV, generator, and mains), monitor tank levels, track temperature measurements, control the shore power input current limit, change settings of the mobile power system **1000**, perform diagnostic tests, or combinations thereof. In aspects, the control computer **502** is configured to monitor a plurality of parameters of the combination inverter charger **600**. An example of a control computer **502** is the CERBO GX® available from Victron Energy.

(37) The control computer **502** is configured to wirelessly connect with a mobile device for monitoring and/or changing parameters of operation of the mobile power system **1000** via user input into the wirelessly connected mobile device.

(38) The control computer **502** on the upper board **500** is operably connected to the battery monitor device **405** on the lower board **400**. The control computer **502** is configured to receive a signal from the battery monitor device **405**, the signal indicating a battery status. The control computer **502** can be configured to store and track battery status over time, and to generate a report of battery status upon from a mobile device that is wirelessly connected to the control computer **502**.

(39) The solar power controller **504** can be positioned on the upper board **500**. The solar charge controller **504** is electrically connected to one of the 24V bus bars **406** and **408** on the lower board **400** and operably connected to the control computer **502**. The solar charge controller **504** can be configured to i) receive a solar power supply from a solar panel, ii) control a flow of 24V power supply to the 24V bus bar, and iii) send a signal to the control computer **502** that indicates solar power usage over time and to track the solar power usage of the mobile power system **1000**. In aspects, the solar charge controller **504**, also known as a solar regulator, can be configured to regulate the power supplied by any solar panels that are connected to the mobile power system **1000**. The solar charge controller **504** is configured to regulate charging of the batteries **301** and **302** in the battery pack **300** using solar power received at the solar charge controller **504** from a solar panel that is connected to the solar charge controller **504**. The solar charge controller **504** can ensure a 24V power supply from the solar charge controller **504** does not overcharge the batteries **301** and **302**. An example of a solar charge controller **504** is the SMARTSOLAR MPPT® Charge Controller available from Victron Energy.

(40) FIG. 6 illustrates a perspective view of the mobile power system **1000** with walls **250**, **251**, **252**, and **253**. The walls **250**, **251**, **252**, and **253** are side walls attached to a perimeter of the equipment cage **200**. The side walls **250/251/252/253**, the top cover **1001**, and the base **100** are configured to enclose the battery pack **300**, the combination inverter charger **600**, and the circuit board **700**.

(41) It can be seen in FIG. 6 that the mobile power system **1000** has a square footprint. It is contemplated that the mobile power system **1000** can have other footprint shapes, such as circular, oval, triangular, or otherwise polygonal.

(42) The dimensions of the mobile power system **1000** are configured so that the mobile power system **1000** can fit within the footprint of a seat of a vehicle. In aspects, the length of the mobile power system **1000** can be in a range of from 1 foot to 3 feet; the width of the mobile power system **1000** can be in a range of from 1 foot to 3 feet; and the height of the mobile power system **1000** can be in a range of from 1 foot to 5 feet. An example size of the mobile power system **1000** is 2 ft in length, 2 ft in height, and 2 ft in width.

(43) FIG. 7 illustrates a wiring diagram of the mobile power system **1000** in FIGS. 1 to 6. The 3D circuit board **700** can be seen with the lower board **400** and upper board **500**; however, the disclosure is not intended to be limited to a lower board **400** and upper board **500**. For example, a 3D circuit board can have a single level or more than two levels.

(44) Independent of the number of levels in the circuit board **700**, the circuit board **700** includes at least two electrical circuits having different voltages, where each of the electrical circuits is electrically connected to the chargers **501**, **503**, **505**, and **506**. One of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the batteries in the battery pack **300** that is onboard the mobile power system **1000**, and the other of the two circuits is for providing power to and using power from the vehicle battery **704** (e.g., a battery for an ICE vehicle or a battery pack for an electric vehicle).

(45) The first voltage circuit having a first voltage, e.g., a 24V circuit having 24V, includes the battery pack **300**, the 24V bus bars **406/407**, the battery monitor device **405**, the control computer **502**, the 24V to 12V chargers **501/503**, the 12V to 24V chargers **505/506**, the solar charge controller **504**, and the combination inverter charger **600**. The first voltage circuit can optionally include the circuit breaker **404**. In the first voltage circuit, power is provided to and used from the battery pack **300**.

(46) The second voltage circuit having a second voltage, e.g., a 12V circuit having 12V, includes the 12V bus bars **402/403/408/409**, the 24V to 12V chargers **501/503**, and the 12V to 24V chargers **505/506**. The second voltage circuit can optionally include the circuit breaker **410**. In the second voltage circuit, power is provided to and used from the vehicle battery **704**.

(47) In operation when connected to an external or outside power source such as the grid **701** or a generator **702**, a first 120V power supply flows from the grid **701** and/or generator **702** to the combination inverter charger **600**, optionally via the circuit breaker **601**. The combination inverter charger **600** provides a second 120V power supply to the electrical outlet **602**, optionally via circuit breaker **603**. Circuit breaker **603** is configured to electrically connect or disconnect the combination inverter charger **600** from the outlet **602** and can be mounted anywhere in the mobile power system **1000** such that the circuit breaker **603** is electrically coupled between the outlet **602** and the combination inverter charger **600**. The combination inverter charger **600** also converts the first 120V power supply to a first voltage power supply (e.g., 24V power supply) that is provided to the circuit board **700**, and particularly, to a first voltage bus bar (e.g., 24V bus bar **406/407**). The first voltage power supply flows from the first voltage bus bar to i) the battery pack **300**, optionally via circuit breaker **404**, ii) the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503**, and iii) the control computer **502**, the solar charge controller **504**, and the battery monitor device **405**. A second voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503** to the vehicle battery **704** via the second voltage bus bar **402/403/408/409** and via an optional circuit breaker **410**. Flow of power to the battery pack **300** and to the vehicle battery **704** charges the batteries in the battery pack **300** and the vehicle battery **704**.

(48) In operation when not connected to an external or outside power source such as the grid **701**, generator **702**, or solar panel **703**, a battery pack power supply flows from the battery pack **300** to the combination inverter charger **600** via the first voltage bus bar **406/407** and optionally via the circuit breaker **404**. The battery pack power supply also flows to i) the control computer **502**, the solar charge controller **504**, and the battery monitor device **405**, and ii) the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503**. A second voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage to second

voltage chargers **501/503** to the vehicle battery **704** via the second voltage bus bar **402/403/408/409** and via an optional circuit breaker **410**. Flow of power to the vehicle battery **704** charges the vehicle battery **704**. The combination inverter charger **600** receives the battery pack power supply from the first voltage bus bar **406/407** and converts the battery pack power supply to the second 120V power supply that is provided to the electrical outlet **602** optionally via circuit breaker **603**. (49) The solar power supply can be used alone or in combination with the other external or outside sources of power **701** and **702**. In operation when connected to the solar panel **703** and the solar panel **703** supplies solar power to the mobile power system **1000**, solar power flows to the solar charge controller **504**. The solar charge controller **504** provides a solar-based first voltage power supply to the first voltage bus bar **406/407**.

(50) In aspects where power supply is provided from external sources **701** and **702** and the solar panel **703**, the solar-based first voltage power supply flows from the first voltage bus bar **406/407** to i) the battery pack **300**, optionally via circuit breaker **404**, ii) the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503**, and iii) the control computer **502**, the solar charge controller **504**, and the battery monitor device **405**. A second voltage power supply generated from the solar-based first voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503** to the vehicle battery **704** via the second voltage bus bar **402/403/408/409** and via an optional circuit breaker **410**. Flow of power to the battery pack **300** and to the vehicle battery **704** charges the batteries in the battery pack **300** and the vehicle battery **704**.

(51) In aspects where power is not supplied from external sources **701** and **702** and is supplied from the solar panel **703**, the solar-based first voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage bus bar **406/407** to i) the battery pack **300**, optionally via circuit breaker **404**, ii) the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503**, and iii) the control computer **502**, the solar charge controller **504**, and the battery monitor device **405**. A second voltage power supply generated from the solar-based first voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage to second voltage chargers **501/503** to the vehicle battery **704** via the second voltage bus bar **402/403/408/409** and via an optional circuit breaker **410**. Flow of power to the battery pack **300** and to the vehicle battery **704** charges the batteries in the battery pack **300** and the vehicle battery **704**. Additionally, the solar-based first voltage power supply can flow from the first voltage bus bar **406/407** to the combination inverter charger **600**. The combination inverter charger **600** receives the solar-based first voltage power supply from the first voltage bus bar **406/407** and converts the solar-based first voltage power supply to the second 120V power supply that is provided to the electrical outlet **602** optionally via circuit breaker **603**.

(52) FIG. 8 illustrates a side view of a van **800** (example of a vehicle) having the mobile power system **1000** inside. The mobile power system **1000** can be seen sitting on the floor **801** of the van **800**; thus, the batteries of the mobile power system **1000** are above the floor **801** of the van **800**. The base of the mobile power system **1000** can be seen connected to seat mounts **802** and **803** in the vehicle van **800**. While shown connected to the seat mounts **802** and **803** of the van **800** in the front passenger seat space, it is contemplated that the mobile power system **1000** can be connected to seat mounts at any other location in the van **800** where seat mounts are present.

ASPECTS

(53) Aspect 1. A mobile power system for equipment in a vehicle, comprising: a base; a battery pack comprising a plurality of rechargeable batteries placed on the base; an equipment cage connected to the base, wherein the equipment cage comprises a mounting member; a circuit board connected to the equipment cage above the battery pack, wherein the circuit board comprises a first electrical circuit operating at a first voltage, a second electrical circuit operating at a second voltage, and a plurality of chargers, wherein each of the plurality of chargers is electrically connected to the first electrical circuit and to the second electrical circuit, wherein the battery pack is electrically coupled to the first electrical circuit, wherein the second electrical circuit is configured to electrically connect to a vehicle battery; and a combination inverter charger placed on

a mounting member of the equipment cage above the battery pack and to a side of the circuit board, wherein the combination inverter charger is electrically connected to the first electrical circuit and is configured to i) provide a first voltage power supply to charge the plurality of rechargeable batteries in the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, ii) receive a battery pack power supply from the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, and iii) provide a first 120V power supply to the equipment in the vehicle.

(54) Aspect 2. The mobile power system of Aspect 1, wherein the combination inverter charger is further configured to i) receive a second 120V power supply from a grid connection or from a generator, and ii) convert the second 120V power supply to the first voltage power supply and to the first 120V power supply.

(55) Aspect 3. The mobile power system of Aspect 1 or 2, wherein the combination inverter charger is further configured to convert the battery pack power supply to the first 120V power supply.

(56) Aspect 4. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 3, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a first voltage bus bar located in the first electrical circuit; and a second voltage bus bar located in the second electrical circuit, wherein each of the plurality of chargers is electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and to the second voltage bus bar.

(57) Aspect 5. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 4, wherein the plurality of chargers comprises: a first voltage to second voltage charger configured to provide a second voltage power supply via the second voltage bus bar using the first voltage power supply received from the first voltage bus bar; and a second voltage to first voltage charger configured to charge the plurality of rechargeable batteries in the battery pack via the first voltage bus bar using a second voltage power supply received from the second voltage bus bar.

(58) Aspect 6. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 5, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a control computer located in the first electrical circuit and electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the combination inverter charger, wherein the control computer is configured to monitor a plurality of parameters of the combination inverter charger.

(59) Aspect 7. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 6, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a battery monitor device located in the first electrical circuit and electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the control computer, wherein the control computer is configured to receive a signal from the battery monitor device that indicates a battery status of the plurality of rechargeable batteries and to track the battery status over time.

(60) Aspect 8. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 7, wherein the battery monitor device comprises a shunt and a shunt computer connected to the shunt, wherein the shunt computer is operably connected to the control computer.

(61) Aspect 9. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 8, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a solar charge controller located in the first electrical circuit and electrically coupled to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the control computer, wherein the solar charge controller is configured to i) receive a solar power supply and ii) control a flow of the solar power supply to the first voltage bus bar, wherein the control computer is configured to receive a signal from the solar charge controller that indicates solar power usage over time and to track the solar power usage.

(62) Aspect 10. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 9, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a lower board, an upper board, and spacers positioned between the lower board and the upper board, wherein the lower board contains at least a portion of the first electrical circuit and at least a portion of the second electrical circuit.

(63) Aspect 11. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 10, wherein each of the plurality of chargers is located on the upper board.

(64) Aspect 12. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 11, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a first circuit breaker configured to electrically connect or disconnect the battery

pack and the first electrical circuit; and a second circuit breaker configured to electrically connect or disconnect a vehicle battery of the vehicle and the second electrical circuit.

(65) Aspect 13. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 12, wherein the equipment cage comprises horizontal members and vertical members, wherein each of the horizontal members connects to two of the vertical members.

(66) Aspect 14. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 13, wherein the base is configured to connect to a seat mount of a vehicle.

(67) Aspect 15. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 14, further comprising a top cover having a circuit breaker and a 120V outlet placed therein, wherein the circuit breaker is configured to connect or disconnect the combination inverter charger and an external power supply, wherein the 120V outlet is electrically connected to the combination inverter charger and configured to receive the first 120V power supply from the combination inverter charger.

(68) Aspect 16. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 15, further comprising: side walls attached to a perimeter of the equipment cage, wherein the side walls, the top cover, and the base are configured to enclose the battery pack, the circuit board, and the combination inverter charger.

(69) Aspect 17. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 16, wherein the circuit board is not made from silicon wafers.

(70) Aspect 18. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 17, wherein electrical components of the circuit board are connected by wires that are not encased in the circuit board.

(71) Aspect 19. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 18, further comprising the vehicle.

(72) Aspect 20. The mobile power system of any of Aspects 1 to 19, wherein the vehicle comprises seat mounts, wherein the base is connected to the seat mounts.

(73) Although the present disclosure and its advantages have been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions and alterations can be made herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure as defined by the appended claims. Moreover, the scope of the present application is not intended to be limited to the particular embodiments of the process, machine, manufacture, composition of matter, means, methods and steps described in the specification. As one of ordinary skill in the art will readily appreciate from the disclosure, processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps, presently existing or later to be developed that perform substantially the same function or achieve substantially the same result as the corresponding embodiments described herein may be utilized according to the present disclosure. Accordingly, the appended claims are intended to include within their scope such processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps.

Claims

1. A mobile power system for equipment in a vehicle, comprising: a base; a battery pack comprising a plurality of rechargeable batteries placed on the base; an equipment cage connected to the base, wherein the equipment cage comprises a mounting member; a circuit board connected to the equipment cage above the battery pack, wherein the circuit board comprises a first electrical circuit operating at a first voltage, and a combination inverter charger placed on a mounting member of the equipment cage above the battery pack and to a side of the circuit board, wherein the combination inverter charger is electrically connected to the first electrical circuit and is configured to i) provide a first voltage power supply to charge the plurality of rechargeable batteries in the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, ii) receive a battery pack power supply from the battery pack via the first electrical circuit, and iii) provide a first 120V power supply to the equipment in the vehicle.

2. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the combination inverter charger is further configured to i) receive a second 120V power supply from a grid connection or from a generator,

and ii) convert the second 120V power supply to the first voltage power supply and to the first 120V power supply.

3. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the combination inverter charger is further configured to convert the battery pack power supply to the first 120V power supply.

4. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a first voltage bus bar located in the first electrical circuit; a second electrical circuit operating at a second voltage; a second voltage bus bar located in the second electrical circuit; a plurality of chargers; and wherein each of the plurality of chargers is electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and to the second voltage bus bar.

5. The mobile power system of claim 4, wherein the plurality of chargers comprises: a first voltage to second voltage charger configured to provide a second voltage power supply via the second voltage bus bar using the first voltage power supply received from the first voltage bus bar; and a second voltage to first voltage charger configured to charge the plurality of rechargeable batteries in the battery pack via the first voltage bus bar using a second voltage power supply received from the second voltage bus bar.

6. The mobile power system of claim 4, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a control computer located in the first electrical circuit and electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the combination inverter charger, wherein the control computer is configured to monitor a plurality of parameters of the combination inverter charger.

7. The mobile power system of claim 6, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a battery monitor device located in the first electrical circuit and electrically connected to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the control computer, wherein the control computer is configured to receive a signal from the battery monitor device that indicates a battery status of the plurality of rechargeable batteries and to track the battery status over time.

8. The mobile power system of claim 7, wherein the battery monitor device comprises a shunt and a shunt computer connected to the shunt, wherein the shunt computer is operably connected to the control computer.

9. The mobile power system of claim 6, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a solar charge controller located in the first electrical circuit and electrically coupled to the first voltage bus bar and operably connected to the control computer, wherein the solar charge controller is configured to i) receive a solar power supply and ii) control a flow of the solar power supply to the first voltage bus bar, wherein the control computer is configured to receive a signal from the solar charge controller that indicates solar power usage over time and to track the solar power usage.

10. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a lower board, an upper board, and spacers positioned between the lower board and the upper board, wherein the lower board contains at least a portion of the first electrical circuit and at least a portion of the second electrical circuit.

11. The mobile power system of claim 10, wherein each of the plurality of chargers is located on the upper board.

12. The mobile power system of claim 4, wherein the circuit board further comprises: a first circuit breaker configured to electrically connect or disconnect the battery pack and the first electrical circuit; and a second circuit breaker configured to electrically connect or disconnect a vehicle battery of the vehicle and the second electrical circuit.

13. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the equipment cage comprises horizontal members and vertical members, wherein each of the horizontal members connects to two of the vertical members.

14. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the base is configured to connect to a seat mount of a vehicle.

15. The mobile power system of claim 1, further comprising a top cover having a circuit breaker and a 120V outlet placed therein, wherein the circuit breaker is configured to connect or disconnect

the combination inverter charger and an external power supply, wherein the 120V outlet is electrically connected to the combination inverter charger and configured to receive the first 120V power supply from the combination inverter charger.

16. The mobile power system of claim 15, further comprising: side walls attached to a perimeter of the equipment cage, wherein the side walls, the top cover, and the base are configured to enclose the battery pack, the circuit board, and the combination inverter charger.

17. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein the circuit board is not made from silicon wafers.

18. The mobile power system of claim 1, wherein electrical components of the circuit board are connected by wires that are not encased in the circuit board.

19. The mobile power system of claim 1, further comprising the vehicle.

20. The mobile power system of claim 19, wherein the vehicle comprises seat mounts, wherein the base is connected to the seat mounts.
